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NORTHFIELD HEALTH

Inpatient and Ambulatory Prior Authorization Workflow

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Section 6.1 Scope

This SOP describes how departmental coordinators handle prior authorization requests for inpatient and ambulatory services.

Section 6.4 Administrative review window

Departmental coordinators are permitted an administrative review window of up to 5 business days before notifying the ordering physician or initiating secondary payer appeals.

Section 6.5 Urgent requests

Urgent requests follow the same review window as standard requests. Coordinators should escalate to a supervisor after the 5 business day window has passed without a payer determination.

Section 6.6 Documentation

Coordinators record the submission date, the payer reference number and each follow-up in the revenue cycle system. Records are retained for 7 years.